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The Typical Millionaire Home

Earlier in this book, I asked you to imagine what a “millionaire” looks like, including how they act, what they drive, how they dress, and where they live. If you started with images of Richie Rich and Scrooge McDuck in your head, it’s time to wake up. We’ve seen over and over that millionaires are regular people—and now I want you to know that these successful men and women live in *regular* homes.

According to our research, the average millionaire lives in a 2,600-square-foot house that they’ve lived in for seventeen years. Depending on what part of the country you live in, that could sound gigantic. However, the average square footage of all homes built in 2015 is 2,687.^{[25](#)} That means, despite their wealth, millionaires live in average-sized homes that they’ve lived in for a long time. These aren’t super-fancy neighborhoods, either. Nearly one-third of millionaires live in a ZIP code where home values are below the national average (\$205,000 or less), and 51% live in neighborhoods where the average household income is \$75,000 or less. Like I’ve been saying, these are regular people who live in predominately average houses. Millionaires don’t feel the need to upgrade, and they aren’t looking for bigger and better simply because they can afford it. Instead, they stay put and actually pay the darn things off.

We found that it took millionaires an average of 10.2 years to pay off their homes, and 67% of them live in homes with paid-off mortgages. This is important, because it puts their home entirely in the asset column of their